

THE ARCHITECTURE

Three Moves, One Vision

The session produced a three-layer architecture. These are not three features. They are three aspects of one integrated product, described through the metaphor the session itself developed: soul, spine, and moat.



The Career Narrative

The Soul

Why exhibitors open the app when there's no show to manage. Tracks each dog's show career as a continuous story — progress toward titles, results history, judge performance, and competitive standing.



The Show Design Engine

The Spine

Why secretaries can't go back to spreadsheets. Treats show scheduling as the constraint-satisfaction problem it actually is, with real-time conflict detection and adaptive day-of management.



The Intelligence Layer

The Moat

What competitors can't replicate by building either pillar alone. When career data and show design data share a platform, capabilities emerge that neither system could produce independently.

MOVE 1

The Career Narrative

The soul — why exhibitors open the app when there's no show to manage.

myK9Show tracks each dog's show career as a continuous story — progress toward titles, results history, judge performance, and competitive standing. The app makes visible what exhibitors already track in their heads and notebooks, and adds strategic intelligence they couldn't generate themselves.

The Post-Show Moment

After a show, exhibitors automatically receive a career update: "Rex earned 2 points today. He now has 13 of 15 toward his Championship." Value arrives uninvited. Each show becomes a distribution event — the primary acquisition mechanism.

The Tuesday Screen

Between shows, the app shows progress bars toward titles, strategic show recommendations, and judge history. This is the fitness tracker energy: you open it because you want to see the number. The habit loop that keeps people coming back.

The Secretary Flywheel

Exhibitor career data powers predictive entry intelligence for secretaries. "If 40 exhibitors within driving distance are 1–2 points from a major, you can predict entry counts with scary accuracy." Each side's engagement makes the other's experience better.

Competitive Awareness

Leaderboards and standings, not friend lists and feeds. The tournament bracket, not the social network. "#1 Golden Retriever in the region just entered the same show as you." The app makes the competition visible.

The First Chapter

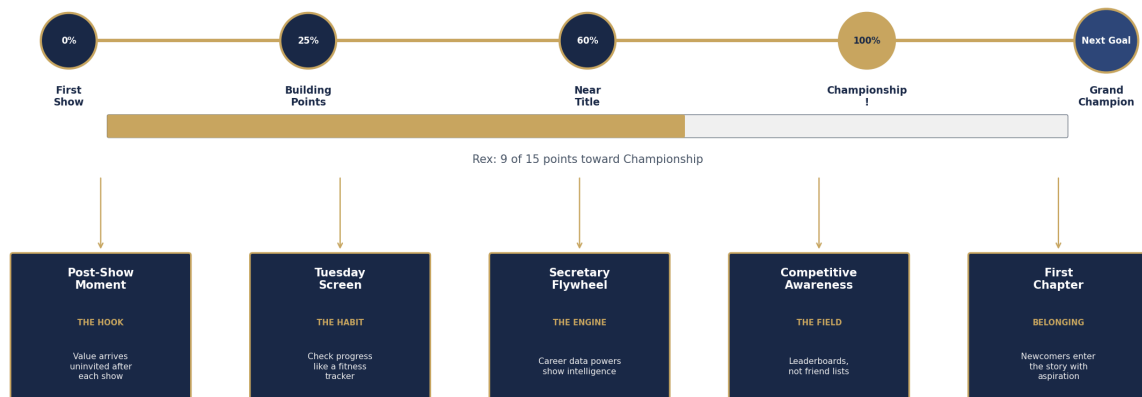
For novices, the emotional hook is belonging, not progress. "Cooper: 1 show, 0 points. Chapter 1 of many."

The career narrative begins with aspiration and contextual guidance — the mentor every newcomer wishes they had.

THE CAREER NARRATIVE

The Soul of myK9Show

"Dog showing is a career, not a transaction"



Each show is a distribution event. The career narrative is the thread that connects hook and habit.

The Career Narrative: hook, habit, and flywheel working as one system

MOVE 2

The Intelligent Show Design Engine

The spine — why secretaries can't go back to spreadsheets.

A typical all-breed show has 150–200+ breeds, 7 groups, 6–10 judges, 4–8 rings — with cascading constraints that secretaries currently manage by hand. The show design engine makes this complexity visible and solvable. It's Google Maps for dog shows: you don't plan a route and then check if it works; you see it updating as you adjust.

Conflict-Aware Design

A real-time dashboard showing all conflicts — judge overlaps, exhibitor time gaps, ring collisions, venue constraints — that updates instantly as changes are made. Combined with what-if simulation: "What happens if Judge Smith cancels?" The secretary answers in seconds questions that currently take hours.

Adaptive Show Day

Show day never goes according to plan. The schedule is alive: when a breed finishes early or a judge runs late, the system adjusts downstream and pushes updates to exhibitors' phones. "Ring 3 is running 15 minutes ahead. Your breed has been moved up. Updated time: 2:15pm."

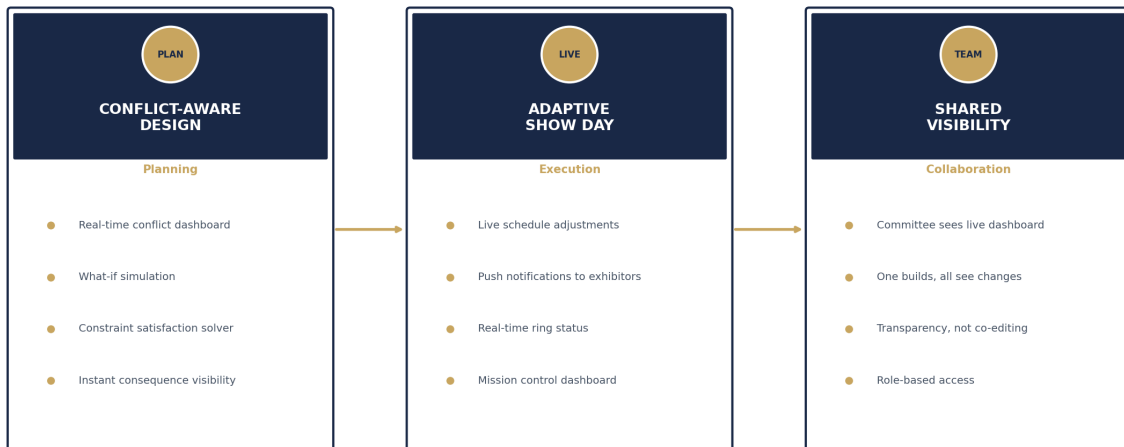
Shared Visibility

Show committees need transparency, not simultaneous editing. The show chair, superintendent, and chief ring steward all see the same live dashboard — current schedule, recent changes, active conflicts. One person builds; the committee sees. Nobody has to ask "where are we?"

THE INTELLIGENT SHOW DESIGN ENGINE

The Spine of myK9Show

"Google Maps for dog shows — see consequences as you adjust"



150+ breeds × 7 groups × 6-10 judges × 4-8 rings = Constraint satisfaction problem

A secretary who runs one show this way doesn't go back to spreadsheets.

The Show Design Engine: from planning through execution to collaboration

MOVE 3

The Emergent Intelligence Layer

The moat — what competitors can't replicate by building either pillar alone.

When career data and show design data share a platform, capabilities emerge that neither system could produce independently. The app transitions from tracker and planner to *strategist*.

Smart Entry Recommendations

Combines career state with show structural data: "The Riverside cluster has Judge Chen on Saturday. You've done well under Chen — 1st, 2nd. Saturday entries suggest a probable major. Enter Saturday for the major

Cross-Show Campaign Optimization

"Springfield cluster — 4 shows over 2 days. Enter Shows 1 and 3 for best major probability. Skip Show 2. Enter Show 4 only if Show 1 doesn't produce your major." You're not managing individual shows — you're managing a

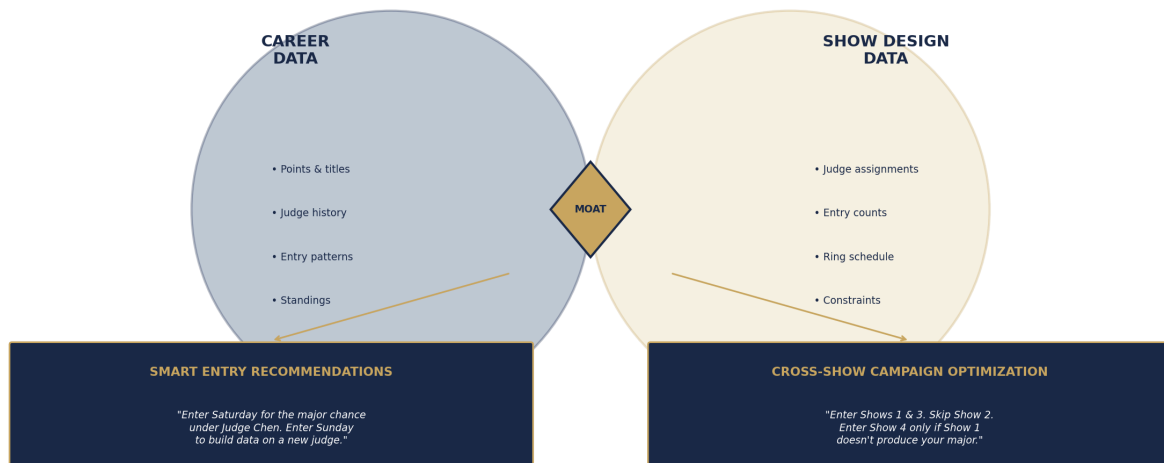
chance. Enter Sunday to build data on a new judge." This is the advice an experienced handler gives over coffee — available to everyone, all the time.

campaign. The app makes cluster strategy data-driven.

THE EMERGENT INTELLIGENCE LAYER

The Moat of myK9Show

"Capabilities that emerge only at the intersection of both pillars"



From tracker and planner to strategist — the app thinks ahead of you.

The Intelligence Layer: where career data meets show data to produce strategic insight

THE SYSTEM

How They Fit Together

The three moves form a reinforcing system, not a feature list. One data model, three experiences. That's why this is a platform, not a collection of features.

Secretary runs show on myK9Show



Exhibitors receive career updates



Exhibitors start tracking careers



Exhibitors ask other secretaries to adopt



More data, smarter intelligence



The career narrative creates exhibitor engagement. That engagement produces data. That data flows into the show design engine, giving secretaries predictive intelligence. Better shows attract more exhibitors. The cycle accelerates.

Monetization Framework

The free tier is not a loss leader — it is the data acquisition layer. Free usage creates the network effects that premium users pay to leverage.

FREE

The Hook & Habit

Free forever

Everything that creates data or drives the flywheel.

- Post-Show Moment notifications
- Basic career page (show history, points, titles)
- Basic show creation and entry management
- Conflict detection dashboard for secretaries

PREMIUM

The Intelligence

~\$9.99–14.99/month or ~\$99–149/year

The free tier tells you where you are. Premium tells you where to go.

- Judge history and performance analysis
- Strategic show recommendations
- Smart Entry Recommendations
- Cross-Show Campaign Optimization
- Competitive awareness

- Advanced career analytics

PROFESSIONAL

The Engine

~\$99–299 per show

Per-show pricing: lower trial barrier, every show is a revenue and distribution event.

- Full show design engine
- What-if simulator
- Adaptive Show Day management
- Shared visibility dashboard
- Predictive entry intelligence
- Auto-generated post-show reports
- Dynamic show marketing tools

SCOPE

What the Product Is Not

Deliberate boundaries that keep the vision focused.

Not a social network



Facebook groups already own the social layer of dog showing. myK9Show's social play is competitive awareness — leaderboards and standings, not friend lists and feeds. Making careers visible is the social strategy. People will do the socializing themselves.

Not a tool for spectators (yet)



The spectator mode concept was explored and grounded as a strategic play for year 2–3, not a core differentiator. The novice exhibitor angle (the "first chapter") was extracted and kept; the broader spectator vision was deferred.

Not a breeding program manager



Multi-generational tracking introduces breeders as a third audience before the exhibitor and secretary experiences are nailed. It's a natural future extension — "a 10-year relationship with the app" — but it's not the current product direction.

Not a B2B data analytics platform (yet)



The Health of the Sport Dashboard was proposed and deferred. It requires massive platform adoption to produce statistically meaningful data. A compelling eventual extension, not a current product direction.

Not a gamification platform





The career narrative tracks real progress toward real titles. The right metaphor is a fitness tracker — simple, addictive, you check the number — not a video game. Progress bars, not skill trees.

Open Questions

Tensions the session identified but intentionally left unresolved.

1. How does the Post-Show Moment reach non-users?

Entry forms contain email addresses. But the first unsolicited contact needs to feel like a gift, not spam. The exact content, timing, and tone of this first touch determines whether the acquisition model works or creates backlash. This is a design problem with regulatory implications.

2. What happens when career data is incomplete?

If some shows use myK9Show and others don't, career pictures have gaps. The app needs to either import historical results from external sources or handle partial data gracefully. The gap between the promise and early reality is a critical UX challenge.

3. How good does the constraint solver need to be at launch?

If the engine produces schedules that experienced secretaries find obviously suboptimal, trust is damaged rather than built. The minimum viable intelligence level needs definition.

4. What's the minimum platform density for the intelligence layer?

Smart Entry Recommendations require data from multiple shows and many exhibitors. Below some threshold, recommendations will be unreliable. What's that threshold, and how does the app provide value during the growth phase?

5. Where exactly is the monetization line?

The conflict dashboard being free could cannibalize professional tier value. The line between "free conflict visibility" and "premium what-if simulation" needs precise

definition. Per-show pricing tiers and subscription transition triggers need market testing.

FUTURE TERRITORY

What Wasn't Explored

Territory the session identified but didn't enter.

The Handler/Agent Perspective

Professional handlers manage multiple dogs for multiple owners. The career narrative maps naturally to "manage your roster" but handler-specific needs weren't explored.

Performance Events

Obedience, agility, rally have different career structures, title paths, and competitive dynamics. The framework should extend but wasn't tested against them.

International Showing

Different registries (AKC, KC, FCI) with different point systems and title structures. The career narrative assumes AKC-style progression. International extension is unscoped.

Integration with Incumbents

InfoDog, ShowEdge, and other tools handle entry processing. How myK9Show coexists with or replaces existing infrastructure during transition was identified but not resolved.

The Data Acquisition Strategy

How the platform bootstraps career data for exhibitors who join after years of showing. AKC data import, manual entry, third-party sources — this infrastructure question remains open.

MATERIALS

Session Resources



Presentation Deck

PowerPoint slide deck of the vision



Vision Document

Full vision in Markdown format



Idea Briefs

Detailed briefs for each of the three moves

myK9Show

Product vision from multi-agent ideation session — February 2026